Sahaj Bhadja

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Mac Walker
Sky Strike
Santa Monica, CA

Dear Mac,

I am interested in contributing to Sky Strike as a software engineer because the work connects directly to the trading desk's decisions. Reliable market data, faster internal tools, and thoughtful automation can help the team capture more opportunities and reduce manual work. Our conversation reinforced my interest in building systems whose value is visible in day-to-day business operations.

I earned my M.S. in Computer Science from USC and have worked on Python, FastAPI, and SQL production systems at USC Dornsife. My work included processing more than 10,000 records, building reconciliation pipelines, and optimizing database queries to reduce an internal dashboard's response time from 1.2 seconds to 350 milliseconds. That experience would inform how I approach Sky Strike's market and event ingestion: validate incoming data, reconcile inconsistencies, and make failures easy to detect and recover from.

For Sky Strike's Local Events App case study, I focused on a small, useful product with a backend that could evolve. I built a FastAPI application with a provider-agnostic event model, an EventProvider interface, and a JamBase integration. The HTTP client handles retries, backoff with jitter, and rate limits, while TTL caching reduces repeated provider requests. Testing against live JamBase data revealed a data-quality edge case that I corrected. I also documented the design choices, limitations, AI-assisted development process, and a path to supporting additional event providers.

I would bring that same practical approach to the desk: first establish a trustworthy data layer, then make inventory, pricing history, positions, and margins easier to inspect, and use those foundations to automate repetitive workflows. I enjoy translating business problems into focused implementations, making tradeoffs explicit, and checking that the result helps the people using it.

Based in Los Angeles, I am available to work with the team in Santa Monica. Thank you for the conversations and the opportunity to demonstrate my approach through the case study. I would welcome the chance to contribute to Sky Strike's engineering work.

Best regards,
Sahaj Bhadja